

**DIFFERENT SURGICAL
PROCEDURE TERMS”**

TERMINOLOGY

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- By the end of this lecture, students should be able to:
 - 1) **Define** common surgical procedure suffixes in medical terminology.
 - 2) **Differentiate** between *-ectomy*, *-otomy*, *-ostomy*, *-plasty*, *-pexy*, *-rrhaphy*, *-desis*, *-lysis*.
 - 3) **Match** surgical procedure terms with the organ or structure involved.
 - 4) **Give examples** of common operations using correct terminology (e.g., appendectomy, colostomy).
 - 5) **Recognize** the difference between diagnostic and therapeutic procedures (e.g., biopsy vs. removal).

INTRODUCTION

Surgery: treatment of disease by **manual or instrumental** procedures.



Medical terminology uses **suffixes** to describe the **type of surgical procedure**.

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- Knowing these suffixes helps students:
 - 1) Understand operation notes
 - 2) Communicate with doctors and nurses
 - 3) Predict the meaning of new terms



OVERVIEW OF COMMON SURGICAL SUFFIXES

-ectomy –
removal,
excision

-otomy –
cutting into,
incision

-ostomy –
creating an
opening (stoma)

-plasty –
surgical repair,
reconstruction

-pexy – fixation, anchoring(gastropexy,orchiopexy.....)

-rrhaphy – suturing, stitching(herniorrhaphy,tenorrhaphy..)

-desis – binding, fusion(arthrodesis,tenodesis.....)

-lysis – loosening, destruction(hemolysis,lipolysis,.....)

GROUP I: -ECTOMY, -OTOMY, -OSTOMY

-ectomy” (Removal /
Excision):

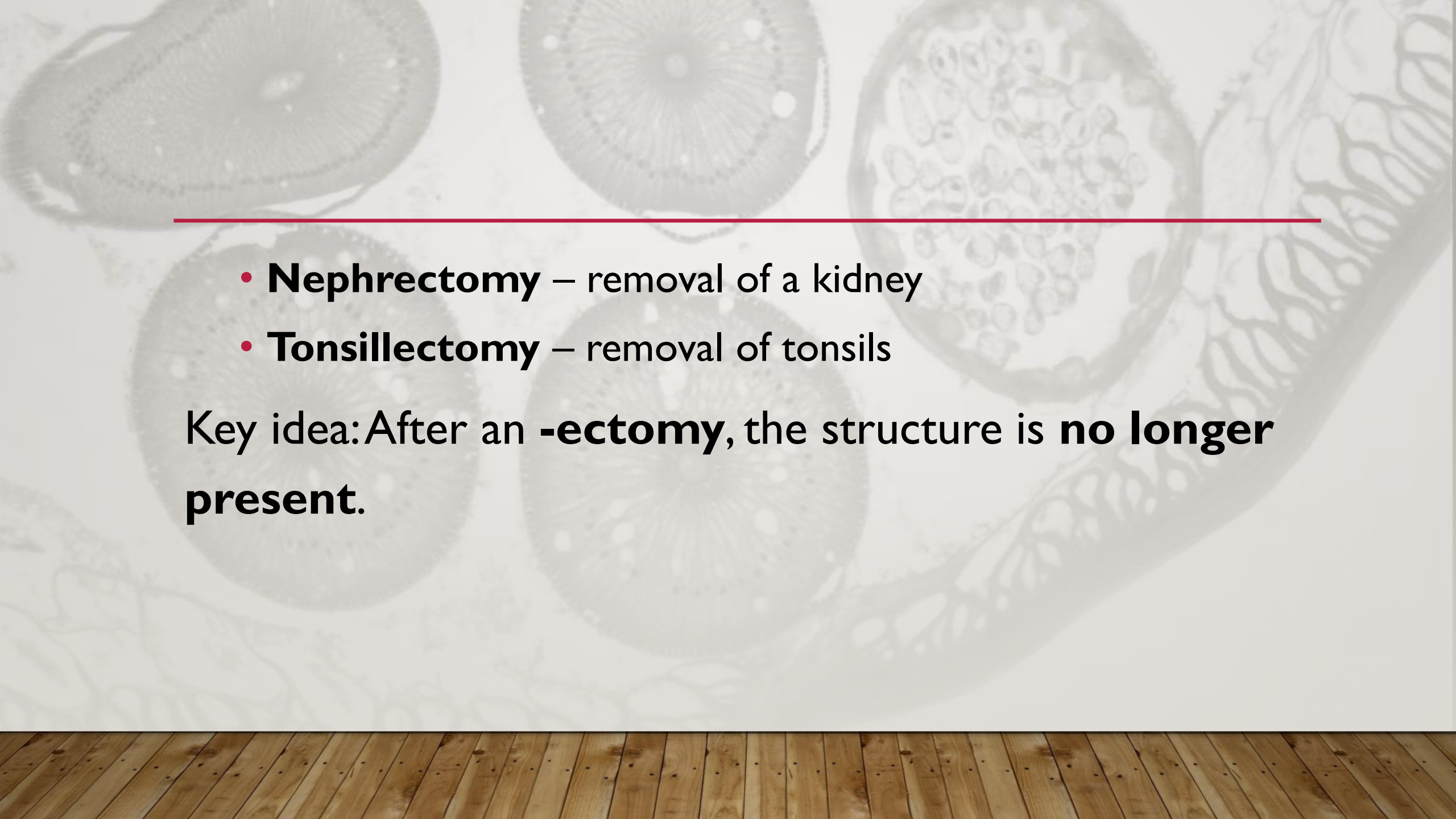
*Surgical removal or
excision of an organ
or part of it.*

Examples:

Appendectomy –
removal of the
appendix

Mastectomy –
removal of the
breast

Cholecystectomy
– removal of the
gallbladder

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- **Nephrectomy** – removal of a kidney
 - **Tonsillectomy** – removal of tonsils

Key idea: After an **-ectomy**, the structure is **no longer present**.

-otomy” (Cutting into / Incision):

Surgical incision into an organ or tissue **without removing it.**

Key idea: -otomy = opening to look, explore, or operate, but organ usually remains.

Examples:

Thoracotomy – incision into the chest wall

Craniotomy – opening into the skull

Tracheotomy – incision into the trachea

Laparotomy – incision into the abdominal cavity

OSTOMY” (OPENING /
STOMA CREATION):

SURGICAL CREATION
OF AN **ARTIFICIAL
OPENING** (STOMA) TO
THE BODY SURFACE.

KEY IDEA: -**OSTOMY** =
NEW OPENING FOR
DRAINAGE, FEEDING,
OR DIVERSION.

Examples:

Colostomy –
opening from colon
to the abdominal
wall

Ileostomy –
opening from ileum
to the abdominal
wall

Tracheostomy –
creating a
permanent opening
into the trachea

Gastrostomy –
opening from the
stomach to the
abdominal wall

COMPARISON: -ECTOMY VS -OTOMY VS -OSTOMY

Suffix	Meaning	Example	What happens?
-ectomy	Removal	Mastectomy	Organ/part removed
-otomy	Incision	Laparotomy	Cut into, then closed
-ostomy	New opening (stoma)	Colostomy	Opening created, may be permanent/temporary

GROUP 2: -PLASTY, -PEXY, -RRHAPHY

-plasty” (Surgical Repair / Reconstruction):

Surgical **repair, reshaping, or reconstruction** of an organ or structure.

Used often in **cosmetic and reconstructive** surgery.



Examples:



Rhinoplasty –
reshaping of the
nose



Angioplasty –
widening of
narrowed blood
vessels



Valvuloplasty –
repair of a heart
valve



Mammoplasty –
reshaping of the
breast



-pexy” (Fixation):



Surgical **fixation** or anchoring of an organ in place.



Key idea: organ is **too mobile or out of place**, so we fix it.

Examples:

Gastropexy – fixing the stomach to the abdominal wall

Nephropexy – fixation of a kidney

Orchiopexy – surgical fixation of an undescended testis

**-rrhaphy”
(Suturing /
Stitching):**

Surgical **suturing**
or repair of
tissue by stitches.

Often used when
something is torn
and needs to be
closed.

Examples:

Herniorrhaphy –
surgical repair of a
hernia (using
sutures)

Tenorrhaphy –
suturing of a
tendon

Neurorrhaphy –
suturing of a nerve

**DESIS, -LYSIS,
OTHER
USEFUL
TERMS**

**desis'' (Binding /
Fusion):**

**Surgical joining or fusion
of two structures.**

**Used to stabilize painful
or unstable joints.**

EXAMPLES:

- **Arthrodesis** – fusion of a joint (e.g., spine, ankle)
- **Spondylodesis** – fusion of vertebrae



**LYSIS” (LOOSENING /
FREEING /
DESTRUCTION):**

**SURGICAL SEPARATION,
LOOSENING, OR
DESTRUCTION OF
ABNORMAL TISSUE.**

**KEY IDEA: BREAKING
DOWN OR FREEING
TISSUES.**

Examples:



Adhesiolysis – cutting bands of scar tissue (adhesions)



Thrombolysis – dissolving a blood clot (can be surgical or medical)

OTHER IMPORTANT SURGICAL TERMS:

Biopsy – removal of a small sample of tissue for diagnosis.



Transplantation – transfer of an organ or tissue from one body to another.



Anastomosis – surgical connection between two tubes (e.g., bowel, blood vessels).



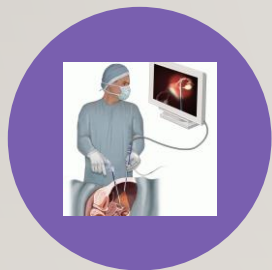
Catheterization – insertion of a tube (catheter) into a body cavity or vessel.



Catheterization – insertion of a tube (catheter) into a body cavity or vessel.



Endoscopy – looking inside body cavities with a camera (e.g., gastroscopy, colonoscopy).



Laparoscopy – endoscopic examination of the abdominal cavity.



Arthroscopy – endoscopic examination of a joint.

SUMMARY:



Surgical procedure terms are often recognized by their **suffixes**.



Knowing meanings of **-ectomy, -otomy, -ostomy, -plasty, -pexy, -rrhaphy, -desis, -lysis** helps you understand many operations.



This is essential for reading **surgical reports, consent forms, and patient notes**.

CASE-BASED EXAMPLES (OPTIONAL ACTIVITY):

A patient with breast cancer undergoes **mastectomy**.

What does **-ectomy** mean here?



A patient has an opening made from the colon to the abdominal wall (**colostomy**).

What does **-ostomy** indicate?

A child with undescended testis has **orchiopexy**.

- What does **-pexy** tell you?

A cosmetic procedure to reshape the nose (**rhinoplasty**).

- What does **-plasty** mean?

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- Thank you

